

NCLT Scraper

A short guide for setting up and running the project on a new Windows laptop. You need Google Chrome, an internet connection, and the NCLT_Scraper folder.

1. Install Python and add it to PATH

- 1 Open Google Chrome and visit the official Python downloads page: python.org/downloads/
- 2 Download the latest stable Windows installer (64-bit).
- 3 Open the downloaded installer file.
- 4 On the first installer screen, tick the box labelled Add python.exe to PATH. The wording may vary slightly, but the PATH option must be selected.
- 5 Click Install Now. Wait for installation to finish, then click Close.
- 6 Close any PowerShell windows that were already open. Open a new PowerShell window.

Check that Python works

TYPE THIS IN POWERSHELL
`python --version`

Correct result

PowerShell should show **Python 3.x.x**. The exact version numbers may be different.

If Python is not recognized

Run the Python installer again, choose Modify, and enable the PATH option. Then close PowerShell and open it again.

2. Open PowerShell and move between folders

- 1 Press the Windows key, type PowerShell, and open Windows PowerShell.
- 2 A window opens with a line similar to PS C:\Users\YourName>. Type commands after the > symbol and press Enter.

COMMAND	WHAT IT DOES
<code>pwd</code>	Show the folder you are currently inside.
<code>dir</code>	Show the files and subfolders in the current folder.
<code>cd "C:\full\path\to\folder"</code>	Move into a folder.
<code>cd ..</code>	Move back one folder level.
<code>cls</code>	Clear the PowerShell screen.

Move into the NCLT_Scraper folder

Use the command matching where you placed the folder. \$HOME automatically means your Windows user folder.

IF THE PROJECT IS IN DOWNLOADS

```
cd "$HOME\Downloads\NCLT_Scraper"
```

IF THE PROJECT IS DIRECTLY IN YOUR USER FOLDER

```
cd "$HOME\NCLT_Scraper"
```

Check that you are in the right folder

Type `dir`. You should see `run_pipeline.py`, `requirements.txt`, and `scraper.py` in the list.

Paths with spaces

Keep quotation marks around a folder path when any folder name contains a space.

Stop a running process

Press Ctrl+C in PowerShell to stop the process currently running.

3. Install requirements once, then run the pipeline

First, use `cd` to enter the `NCLT_Scraper` folder as shown on page 2.

FIRST TIME ON THIS LAPTOP ONLY

```
python -m pip install -r requirements.txt
```

Wait until installation finishes and the PowerShell prompt appears again. You do not need to run this command before every pipeline run.

RUN THE COMPLETE PIPELINE

```
python run_pipeline.py
```

While it is running

Keep the laptop awake, keep the internet connected, and do not close PowerShell or the Chrome windows opened by the project. When PrivateCircle opens, log in yourself. The debt enricher continues automatically when Company Master List is ready.

The run is finished when PowerShell displays **[DONE] PIPELINE EXECUTION FINISHED!**

4. Where the output will be

Every run automatically creates a new date-and-time folder inside `NCLT_Scraper\outputs`.

OUTPUT FOLDER FORMAT

```
NCLT_Scraper\outputs\YYYY-MM-DD_HH-MM-SS
```

EXAMPLE

```
$HOME\NCLT_Scraper\outputs\2026-07-17_10-30-00
```

The completed run folder normally contains:

COMMAND	WHAT IT DOES
Consolidated_IBC7_Master_...xlsx	Section 7 cases found and checked by the scraper and audit.
CIN_Directory_...xlsx	Companies matched with CIN numbers.
PrivateCircle_Company_Debt_Profile_...xlsx	PrivateCircle financial and debt results.